

[request] what's the environmental cost of an AI model?

Posted by u/the_last_lemurian • 0 points • 146 comments

I know the post exaggerated it by using "AGI" which might not be a thing (yet). But realistically what's the actual impact of AI requests?

Comments

u/DullCryptographer758 • 1 points • 2025-04-15 02:42 UTC

You can locally run some AI that are pretty close to web run models if you have good hardware. Training industrial models is super resource intensive, inference isn't nearly as bad (but it does scale)

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-04-12 05:19 UTC

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u/Designer_Version1449 • 1 points • 2025-04-11 23:44 UTC

Asking an ai isn't "producing" carbon. Not using AI will not solve climate change. If it does create CO2, that means your power generation is screwed up. If all our grids were on nuclear and solar and whatnot, ai would not have any environmental cost(other than the cost of construction, which is miniscule compared to like, cities, or the resources used to build the computer you're typing on)

u/AngusAIThor • 1 points • 2025-04-11 21:42 UTC

AI companies are actively hiding their emissions and costs, so we don't really know. The best estimates I've seen come from [this video by Simon Clark](<https://www.google.com/url?sa=t&source=web&rct=j&opi=89978449&url=https://www.youtube.com/watch%3Fv%3D5sFBySzNIX0&ved=2ahUKEwjWwoTP-NCMAxWfUGcHHduoEJEQwqsBegQIDBAF&usg=AOvVaw2EyR11xeOmkkIRKGnNAM2G>), but there is a lot of "We're not sure".

However, the short answer is that AI is significantly more energy intensive than the alternative. For a Google Search, the AI powered alternative is about 70x as polluting as the originalalgorithmic search.

u/Aetze • 1 points • 2025-04-11 20:14 UTC

Why do people depict "AIs" always as such mighty or great beings? Its literally just a blackbox that sorts data, all it will ever do. There is no AI only other peoples data

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-04-11 19:19 UTC

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